

A different OUTLOOK

We take you beyond the Send/Receive button. Make Microsoft Outlook work for you

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E-mail clients are available by the dozen. Half of them are free to use. What makes Microsoft Outlook a favoured choice? Outlook is more than an e-mail client: it is a personal information manager; it is a tool for collaboration; it is a task master. Deeply tied to the other Microsoft Office modules such as Word, Excel and even Messenger, Outlook delivers a comprehensive and single package for working smart. Let's take a look at how Outlook can do more than Send/Receive. Note that all the following is only valid for Microsoft Outlook 2000 and above.

Sum Of The Parts

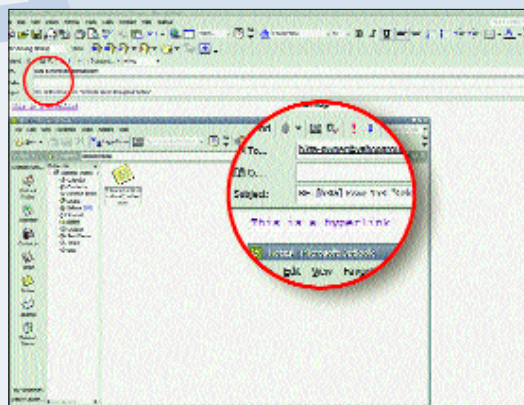
Outlook consists of six interconnected modules. It oversees your e-mail; tracks your meetings and appointments via a calendar; has a database of your contacts; maintains a list of all your assigned, pending and completed tasks; automates a journal that tracks your e-mails and other documents; and, finally, lets you take ad-hoc "sticky" notes. These modules form the heart of Outlook. More importantly, these are interdependent and interconnected. For

To link to this module	Use this code
Inbox	outlook:inbox
Contacts	outlook:contacts
Calendar	outlook:calendar
Notes	outlook:notes
A mailbox folder	outlook:foldername\subfolder
A specific message in your mail folder	outlook:inbox/~subject of message
A specific contact in your Contacts folder	outlook:contacts/~name of contact

example, dragging the content of an e-mail from the inbox to the Notes shortcut on the Outlook Bar will create a new note with the dragged text.

This brings us to an interesting way of cross-referencing each of these modules within an e-mail. An HTML mail may contain hyperlinks; you can tell Outlook to jump between modules by using the codes alongside as hyperlinks inside a mail.

This is especially useful if you



Upon clicking this hyperlink, Outlook will take the reader of the e-mail to the Notes folder

share contacts or the calendar with co-workers and friends: as an example, you can link to a shared e-mail as a means of reference. To hyperlink a text, make sure you are creating an HTML mail first, then right-click on the text to be hyperlinked and use the codes alongside within the "Address" field.

Dial D For Delegate

You can assign a task to your co-worker. An assigned task is e-mailed to the person(s) you have delegated it to. To assign a task, right-click on a task and select "Assign Task," type an e-mail id in the "To" field, or click the

"To" button and choose a name from your contacts list. To track the progress of the task, tick the box marked "Keep an updated copy of this task on my Task List." Any changes the recipient makes to the task as it progresses will appear in your Task List.

If you'd like to be notified when a project is complete, tick the box marked "Send me a status report when this task is complete." You can also add any comments you'd like to in the window at the bottom of the dialog box.

Mail En Masse

It is a good idea to file a contact under a category. For example, everyone from the online team of your organisation can go under, well, "Online Team." This way it becomes easier to send a mass mail to everyone within the online team: in the Contacts module, select **View > Current View > By Category** from the menu bar. Now select a category ("Online Team," in our example) and drag it to the Inbox icon on the Outlook Bar. Outlook will generate an empty e-mail message and fill the "To" field with the e-mail addresses of all the contacts in that category.

Vote For Outlook

When you are not sure about how to take a task further, do what the pros do: vote on it!

When creating a new e-mail, click the Options button. Select the "Use voting buttons" checkbox, and select the voting button names you want to use in the box. These buttons will appear at the top of the mail you will send. To create custom buttons, type in any text you want, making sure to separate